

find it is much easier to play games with them, as opposed to a console where one has to first get used to a gamepad. Multiplayer online gaming is another big positive for PCs. All you need is a legitimate copy of the game and a decent Internet connection and you're good to go.

Nothing in life is perfect though, and the PC is no exception. The biggest drawback of the PC is the fact that one needs to upgrade the hardware on a regular basis to play the newer games. With newer games pushing the envelope in terms of sheer power, often the low and mid-range systems can't keep up. Thus, to stay contemporary one needs a bank account the size of London!

Then there's the ever-present problem of viruses. All it takes is one mistake and your computer could be lost forever. Not only does that mean giving up games until the problem is solved (an appalling suggestion in itself), it also means that if you've not backed up your game's 'save' files, you will lose all your progress (major bummer).

5.22 Consoles are not bad either

Consoles have been around much longer than the PC. From the humble beginnings of the very first Nintendo console to the ultra-modern PS2 or Xbox, it's been a long journey for the gaming devices. With the PS3 and Xbox 360 all set to rock the world, it really is a great time to be a console gamer.

Consoles score big points where hardware is concerned, even though they effectively run on relatively old PC hardware. This is because all the games are optimised for that particular piece of hardware. If we take a look at the graphics, e.g., a PC game has to be built assuming that the gamer could be using either a low- or a top-end graphics card, and the game must perform acceptably in either case.

